

Javelin like most days was sitting on the steps of The Hall of Might. The noise of politicking drowned most people sense dull but not Javelin to many years with that old bastard Faust. The amount of times he kept playing that god damn bagpipe especially on crucial points “fuck that man, he always found a way to kick the floor out my feet....” He says finally being able to ignore the noise and focus on the real objective.

As he stares at the people walking around he notices something subtle, its too minute but there a split second and slight heat wave, and a noise that was so cleverly hidden behind the steps of women walking on high heels, he inhales and moments later he feels it, the warm air around him suddenly chills, even just so slightly. As he turns around. Just an instant too late. Just on purpose, just enough to help. His would be attacker. Believe that he had the upper hand. Quietly says. Quotation marks. Ah, I see. You know, you’re getting very sloppy. I don’t remember teaching you how to be this. Could it be that someone else is influencing you, my Prince? Or is it that it’s so easy for you? To forget where a lineage starts, end quotation marks.

I’m sorry, Javelin, but I believe that. On this occasion I seem to have the upper hand. End quotation marks. The Prince says as he is holding a knife. That is dull. To the neck of javelin.

Javelin, says my Prince. Again. You seem to forget. About the Royal jewels. And javelin. Grabs. And pushes. Not menacingly, but firmly against the Prince. ‘s. Private areas.

Quotation marks. You see, my Prince? There’s always someone that is willing to be just one more step ahead of you. End quotation marks, Javelin says. In a smug tone.

The Prince scoffs and says as if that would be a deterrent. The air shifts. And a ripping noise that is very audible. Is heard across the hall. As Javelin and the Prince are. Are pulled into the air moments ago the. Rip in the air is sewn back shut, leaving many to wonder if it ever really happened. In a new room. Isolated and secluded from the world, the Prince. And javelin. Stand knives no longer at each other’s body, but. Javelin behind. The Prince in a. Intimate, almost delicate fashion holding him. This time, instead of a knife at his throat. Are two precise fingers. Delicately placed on his carotid, poised. To strike.

Javelin looks at Rax And asks Why did you bring us here in my liege? You know this can be looked at as in. Gross indecency. On both our.

The Prince. Responds. It’s only an impropriety. If I was not. Who I was. But also, didn’t you teach me? To always look at the excitement of life.

RAX. Subtly grabs Javon’s hand from his neck. And turns around. And holds him by the waist. And says

Risk and adventure always what makes passion? More than anything.

Javelin looks. He gives them a smile. Before a shock of recognition and surprise. He understands that Javelin needs this. He deserves it. To believe that he had won over. M. To see him or believe him to unsettled him. Javelin. The look on his eyes, the gentleness around his face, and the warmth in his eyes that spoke of. Careless and unbridled. Passions yet to be tapped, yet to be explored. And yet Javelin knew. That certain things could not happen. Not now. Maybe not ever. As the moments passed and both of them see into each other's eyes. Javelin can feel the. Intensity of. RAX. And sedily says.

RAX. This isn't proper.

He grabs his hand And takes it off. Of his chest. Slightly moving it towards his face. Just close enough where his lips touch and he can sense the smell of. The aromas. Let linger from all of his. Work and all of his duties a distinct aroma that. Gives him not only his magical signature, but. A sense of presence whenever he steps the room. He stands tall. In streets and directs himself to the Prince

My Prince this was very. Poorly done. First of all. You came up against an opponent that already knew your signature, as I just. Demonstrated, and you did a poor job at hiding it. Secondly, when you blinked us. Back to this room. You made an awful noise about it anyone could have seen. Anyone with the right senses did I not teach you right? Ah.

What will the Emperor say? How can I even hold my head up high? Knowing that my dear apprentice is nothing more than pretending to be a charlatan with all of the tasks that I have given him, and have done so magnificently. Now he chooses. To disgrace me.

Javelin. Crumbles to the floor in a dramatic Expose of a downtrodded. Teacher with a woeful student.

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Rax stairs in disbelief

I have just. Successfully. Grappled you. And transported you to a new location and you dare tell me? That I am failing you.

How can it be when all I do is slay away? Dealing with. You. God, if only my Father hadn't given me such a hard teacher.

Rax Emphasizes on the word hard. And says

Well, if a failure I must be. Then at least I am your failure. Today I'm with my father and to damn with whatever institution says I should be.

Javelin, if I'm honest. Tell me.

He takes a pause.

Javelin, looking into his eyes, can sense the question coming up and suddenly. Raises his arm. To his shoulder and says. N

If you are my failure and my shame, then I will bear it. Proudly and willing. Yet a Prince of the Empire must always be proper and direct. They are not. The first among equals, but the last among them. First. To the slaughter. Lest to the riches is that not? The lessons that your father has tried to instill in you. N

Trust me, my friends. A time will come when you can. Freely and truly be yourself. But until then. We must dance. The careful. And delicate. Dance. Of politics.

Javelin sees as the Prince. Seems. Disheartened, but at the same time understands. At his last words, he understands that. You know, whatever he feels and whatever he understands. Is only temporary until he comes to his own. That at least gives him hope, and that at least kills him. A sense of hope. In wonder.

'cause Javelin is explaining this to him and giving him. This explanation. He notices at the corner of his eye a slight flicker. In the moment, he hears. Arriving. Car a subtle but slight sharp. RIP and then the unmistakable. Sense. Grime. And somewhat of sulfur.

He looks at the Prince, and says, my Prince. The session has been an important one. I do believe that for the nuns. We are done. And I also believe that it is time for you to present yourself to your father. For the daily briefing, I understand that. There is to be. A gala. In a couple of hours, which I assume you will not want to miss. Don't worry, I will be there myself as well. But for now, go.

The Prince looks at javelin and senses. Tone that isn't usual for. Him something sounds a little bit more forced, as if there is business afoot or as if there is a new. Flavor in the air. He understands and nods and says.

Until then, javelin. Thank you.

He proceeds to do something that he only does whenever. They are around dignitaries and people of rank and extends his hand and. Expects javelin. To kiss the signet ring, that is. The totem of the Prince. Or Emperor. Errant.

Javelin sees the gesture and with quiet equanimity accepts kneeling and kissing he ring, although he lingers, even the touch and warmth of his princess hand is enough to make him understand and grieve the more for the lost

Once the symbolic gesture was done. The Prince walks away in a regal fashion. Straight backed regal bearing. With an authority that. Speaks of his lineage and how he presents himself to the court.

As soon as. Door closes. In knife is thrown across the room and embeds itself. A couple inches away from the corner of the room where the shadows converge in the darkest place is made.

A voice. Grasp, slow and deep. Saying isn't that. A bad way? Greeting one's own master.

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Javelin looks at the shadow. And addresses. Faust. N

Faust Slowly and very deliberately. Exits from the shadow, revealing himself. A diminutive man. Somewhere between. A dwarf and a midget The only man that. Javelin has ever faced or have ever known. To unsettle him to the depths of no understanding. This was his master, the man his father. Hired for so long. To teach him the ways of survival, not only. Within the. Or the Senate. Or the nobility. But also in the subtle arts of knife work and. Through limited understanding of his own the workings of magic. N

Javelin addresses Faust. Saying

And what is it that my father would like to know? If it's not that, I am doing exactly what he asked me to.

Faust laughs. And says well. Your father wouldn't have sent me if he didn't have any reservations about how you were dealing with. Your students. Clearly from what I see. There's more than just a professional interest in this now, isn't it?

Javelin. Stops him and says I have it under control. The Prince is learning he is far better than I could have expected at his age. Granted, we started very late. Not all of us have.

Javelin says the next line with. A sense of vile in his voice.

The privilege of starting at such a young age. As my father thought it was appropriate.

Faust almost wounded. And a little disheartened, says. He only did it because he loved you. He tried you because he thought. He would survive. Trust me. Javelin, you do not know your father have as well as you should, nor will you ever. Do so if you continue this path. But. This relationship.

He says this with a delicacy that Javelin has never really heard in his voice. This makes him want to listen. But. Even though he knows that he doesn't want to, he still bites his son. And looks away but says nothing. N

Is very dangerous for you. And if not for you, then at least for the Prince. Himself. You do know? At a dynasty must continue.

Javelin turns around and looks as a former master and says. Do you not think I know that? Do you not think that that is why I sent him away before? You decided. To show yourself. I knew you were here and I explicitly told him to get out. You know that. I know that. I know damn well that if you wanted to, I would have never known you were here. So I don't know how much you saw before you made yourself present, nor will I want you. To tell me. But understand this. I know my place. And I don't. Expect to rise above it.

First, visibly. Stable and stoic. Though round his eyes, you notice a certain softness. A certain pity for his. And says. N

That is the price that every good man must pay. And where no exceptions. Even those of us that are a helpful blade. In the dark. Must always remember. That a knife that can be pulled on one. Can be pulled. On themselves as well. N

Hours later after this encounter. Javelin is sitting or standing in front of a mirror. Closely, meticulously looking at his garments. For the night's galah, he is chosen in emerald green. Attire. With an elegant. High neck. And as for most of. The people in his profession each. Carefully tailored with specific pouches. To hold various. Tools of the trade, be it pick locks. Poisons. Darts. Knives. Not being a official Magic user, he still carries. Various Trinkets. Honest person that allow him to channel the limited magical abilities that he possesses. Toward specific actions And effects.

As he scans and surveys himself in front of the mirror, checking that his hair, his attire, every inch of him is presentable and well. Respectable. Not only does he have to be a representative for his father's family and as his heir, but also he must present himself as. Wrigley as most any other noble born. Regardless of status.